



12-13-2022 MCS Board Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=jdHqBwuY-Z0
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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Muncie Community Schools Board of School Trustees

Format: Structured Municipal Meeting Analysis

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Williams called the meeting to order [00:00:20](#), asking attendees to rise for a moment of silence remembering Kim Roberts, a South Side teacher who recently passed away [00:00:30](#), followed by the Pledge of Allegiance [00:01:24](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** President Williams, Dr. O'Neill, Mr. Heater, Dr. Bales, Mrs. Barnes Griffin, Mr. Irvin, Mr. Wright.
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Williams.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**

- The Pledge of Allegiance was led by students from Northview Elementary (Alexander Hess, Charlotte Hess, Landon Bales, Malachi, Charlotte Cox, Violet Johnson, and Ben Johnson) 00:01:24.
 - Northview Elementary students presented handmade collaborative wall-hanging artwork crafted from individual popsicle sticks to the board members 00:03:34.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** *(Not explicitly detailed in the transcript text).*
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:03:11 Northview Elementary School Annual Presentation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Principal Aisha Allen.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Principal Allen shared enrollment updates (noting growth and added sections in 1st and 3rd grades), academic goals for ELA, math, and writing based on iLearn and i-Ready data, weekly professional development via PLCs, the “Rocket Attendance Award” initiative, and community partnerships (Ball State University, Muncie Fire Department, Meridian Health Services). Board members praised Principal Allen’s leadership and discussed building capacity and future space needs.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board vote required.
- **00:19:24 Muncie Central High School Student Advisory Board Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Student representatives (sophomore advisory member and Jamar Clark) alongside staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Students reported on the success of their first Fall Festival, efforts to reopen the “Cat Cave” and library, student mentorship programs, and better advertising/resource distribution for student pantries while addressing student stigma.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no vote required.
- **00:32:43 Personnel Recommendation: Latin Teacher Hire**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Zachary Hauser / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Zachary Hauser was recommended to fill the open Latin position at Muncie Central High School effective January 2nd, following his student teaching and service as a permanent substitute.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (part of Consent Agenda).
- **00:36:24 YMCA & Muncie Central High School Collaboration Agreement**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Detailed a nearly \$30 million public-private partnership capital investment project involving a new YMCA facility adjacent to Muncie Central

High School. The agreement provides long-term use for water sports, physical education, and avoids over \$7 million in rehabilitation costs for the existing Muncie Central natatorium. Board member Mr. Heater noted his upcoming non-financial board service on the YMCA and confirmed conflict-of-interest disclosures.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:39:59 Memorandum of Understanding (MOU): YMCA & Muncie Area Career Center (MACC)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Administration / Caleb Beasley.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Outlined shared services, classroom spaces, and career/technical education rotations at the YMCA facility (servicing an estimated 300 students annually) for programs including EMT training, CCMA, early childhood education, anatomy, Kinesiology, CPR, lifeguard training, adult ESL, and high school equivalency.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:43:13 Financial Reports (11-Month November Report)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Jerome (Chief Financial Officer).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reported state basic grant revenue up \$1.8 million compared to the previous year (totaling nearly \$42.4 million). Total checkbook balance stood at over \$39 million at the end of November, with \$13.9 million set aside in the rainy day fund. Long-term debt to the state is reduced to \$10.5 million. The district successfully transitioned to a new cloud-based software system.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:46:34 School Calendar Amendments & Adoption**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Reynolds.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented amendment requests for the 2022-2023 calendar (adding Juneteenth) and the 2023-2024 calendar (moving the educational summit one week later to avoid ADM count day conflicts, and adjusting parent-teacher conference hours to include evening slots and early release). Full adoption of the 2024-2025 calendar was also proposed, aligning spring break with traditional county school schedules.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:48:36 Teacher Appreciation Grant Stipends**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Bell.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Outlined distribution of state grant funds for licensed teachers based on 2021-2022 evaluations. Highly effective teachers (103 total) will receive \$661.02; effective teachers (170 total) will receive \$495.77 (totaling 273 eligible teachers), payable on December 16th.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:52:46 Instructional Specialist Job Description**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Bell.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presented new academic-focused instructional specialist positions to support reading and math at Grissom and Southview schools, with an hourly pay rate of \$17.50 (exceeding standard instructional aide pay).
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:53:50 Middle School Novel List Additions**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grimm / Dr. Binko.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed additions of diverse, modern novels to the middle school approved reading list in partnership with Ball State University Professional Development Schools (PDS) liaison work, vetted using content review resources like Common Sense Media.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.
- **00:58:03 Civics Textbook Adoption (*We the People*)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mr. Grimm / Dr. Roof.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Proposed adoption of the *We the People* textbook (authored by the Center for Civic Education) for sixth-grade classrooms starting in the 2023-2024 school year, funded via a Ball State grant to align with state-mandated sixth-grade civic standards.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:01:46 Aquila M. Nasakuri (Director, Muncie Public Library):** Addressed the board to celebrate five years of successful partnership regarding the READ online catalog program, delivery services, expansion into Inspire Academy and the Youth Opportunity Center (YOC), and collaborative literacy initiatives alongside Ball State University and the United Way. She also highlighted staff recognition (Katie Lehman named state youth worker of the year) and introduced incoming library liaison Laura Geezy.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Superintendent Dr. Kowalski announced upcoming holiday music performances across district schools (Grissom, Northview, Northside, Southside, and Central) and

noted ongoing cradle-to-career work with the George and Francis Ball Foundation involving 57 supporting organizations.

- Panther Pantry donations exceeded \$17,000 in the past month.
- Board member Mrs. Barnes Griffin suggested exploring a digital donation platform for the Panther Pantry.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned following a motion and second approved by voice vote 01:08:34.

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